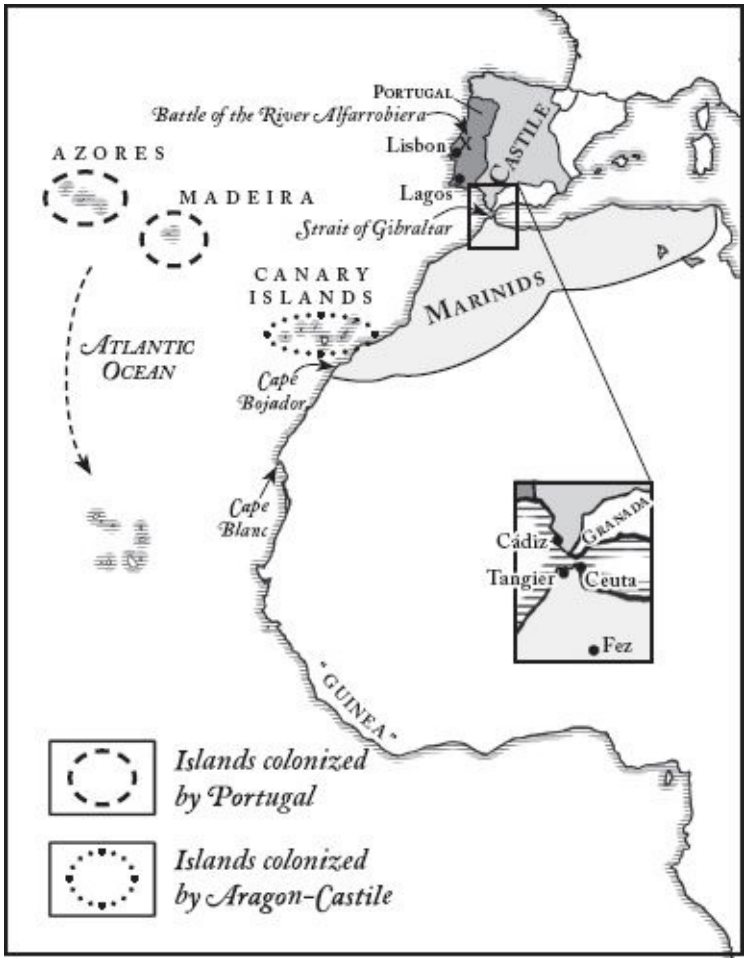


92.1 Portuguese Explorations

When yet more Marinid reinforcements arrived, sent from the Marinid sultan in Fez, Henry was forced to give up. He managed to negotiate the freedom of most of his men by promising to give up Ceuta, but he was obliged to leave Ferdinand and twelve other Portuguese knights as hostages to assure the city's surrender.

But the Cortes refused to honor Henry's promise. Ferdinand remained in miserable captivity in Fez, chained in a cell at night and forced to do backbreaking work with other prisoners during the day.

Edward died eleven months later—of plague, according to some accounts; of a deep despair and guilt over his brother's fate, according to others. His six-year-old son Afonso became king of Portugal, with Edward's widow Eleanor and his brother Peter of Coimbra as uneasily cooperating co-regents.

Henry, back in Ceuta, was powerless to negotiate Ferdinand's release; and in 1443, the youngest Portuguese prince died in captivity. By then, Henry's expeditions had resumed. He had settled Portuguese families on the Azores, the cluster of islands west of Portugal. And his men had finally come face-to-face with the inhabitants of the African coast: "black Moors," whom they had